

MICHAL VARDA WOLLNER

ECO.URBANISM

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Valid Danish/EU work permit



PROFILE

Landscape architect and planner with ten years of experience in nature-based, ecological and climate-adaptive planning, from strategic frameworks to built projects, for municipalities and regional authorities in Israel, alongside a research background from my MSc at the University of Copenhagen. In both research and practice, my work increasingly focuses on one question: how to combine spatial-ecological data and social data into a single, holistic reading of how well a place serves people and ecosystems, most recently through a GIS-based quality index I built for Tel Aviv-Jaffa's public realm.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2021 – now

Michal Wollner – Eco.Urbanism

Founder · Israel / Denmark · Public authorities, regional councils and planning offices

- Lead urban-scale and infrastructure-related projects from concept to implementation; coordinate multidisciplinary teams and stakeholders; develop nature-based strategies for public space and resilience.
- “Public Infrastructure” – strategic framework for Tel Aviv-Yaffo, building on my MSc thesis research: a holistic planning methodology, a purpose-built GIS (QGIS) analysis tool, and a quality-measurement index for the public realm.
- Led a strategic, basin-wide master plan (≈630 km²) for the Kishon and Harod river corridors – an ecological corridor from the Mediterranean coast to the Jordan Valley, with LYGM Studio.
- Native planting design for a restored Mediterranean stream corridor (75,000 m²), Lod Municipality – habitat-led riparian design with 157 native and endemic species, with MKR Architects.
- “Mediterranean Forest-Neighbourhood” – an urban planting-systems masterplan (236,000 m²) for Lod Municipality, with Zura Studio.
- Regional master plan for overnight-camping sites across the Upper Galilee, balancing tourism growth with ecological conservation.
- Water research and education visitor centre, Shafdan (client: Igudan) – under construction.
- Execution plan for an educational agricultural farm in the Upper Galilee.
- Water-body and stream restoration projects across Israel, from strategic planning to construction.
- “Quarrying Promises” – a conceptual regenerative-tourism master plan for a former quarry site.

2019 – 2022

MKR Architects ↗

Team Leader & Landscape Architect · Israel

- Led design of large-scale urban and landscape projects; contributed to masterplans integrating public space, infrastructure and ecology; coordinated across architecture, engineering and planning.
- Arid-climate planting design for a coastal desert promenade, Eilat – drought- and salt-tolerant species as the primary shading and microclimate tool.
- Arava Delta – wetland habitat and planting design for a canal-to-delta transformation.
- Eilat Coastal Strip Master Plan – a landscape-led strategy balancing tourism growth with a thriving coastal “bluescape”.

2016 – 2018

LYGM | Environmental Projects ↗

Team Leader & Landscape Architect · Israel

- Regional landscape planning and ecological restoration projects, with planners, ecologists and engineers.

2016 – 2017

Zura Studio ↗

Landscape Architect · Israeli-Spanish studio

- Urban tree planting systems and nature-based solutions for renewal areas.

EDUCATION

2021 – 2023

MSc Landscape Architecture (Cand.hort.arch.)

University of Copenhagen · Dept. of Geosciences and Natural Resource Management

- Thesis “Urban Synergy: Towards Mediterranean Eco-Urbanism” (2023) – interviews with municipal planners, GIS analysis and site observation building a Nature-Based Solutions and rewilding framework for climate resilience in Tel Aviv-Yaffo. Co-supervised by Assoc. Prof. Ole Fryd and Prof. Anne Tietjen. Grade 12/12.
- Research project “Enhancing Social Resilience using Mediterranean Urban Green Infrastructure: Barcelona and Tel-Aviv-Yaffo” (2022), under Assoc. Prof. Natalie Marie Gulsrud.
- Coursework: “Urban Nature – Naturpark Nordhavn” (2022); “Low-Impact Recreation and Forest Biodiversity – Vestsboen” (2022).

2012 – 2016

BLA Landscape Architecture

Technion – Israel Institute of Technology

- Magna Cum Laude. Exchange at UNSW Sydney, 2015.

SKILLS

Urban landscape & masterplanning

Nature-based solutions

Climate adaptation

Biophilic urban design

Habitat-based planting design

Native & endemic plant systems

Project & design leadership

Statutory planning documents (Hebrew, English)

Municipal & multidisciplinary coordination

TOOLS

QGIS · spatial analysis & custom tools

AutoCAD

Rhino

Adobe Creative Suite

AWARDS

KU

Danish Governmental Award for Academic Excellence

Technion

Yechiel and Yosef Segal Award for Excellent BLA Thesis (1st place)

LANGUAGES

Hebrew

Native

English

Professional working proficiency

Danish

Beginner (learning)

REFERENCES

Assoc. Prof. Ole Fryd and Prof. Anne Tietjen (MSc thesis co-supervisors). Contact details and professional references on request.